STATE SCAN

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OPTIMUM OPTICS Telangana CM Revanth Reddy at his grandson's aksharabhyasam ritual at the Gnana Saraswati Temple, Basara, Apr. 6

▶ TELANGANA

REVANTH'S TEMPLE REVAMP

The Congress CM slathers on a new coat of paint on Telangana's temple circuit, with mammoth projects—one complex getting renovated is his own political image

By **Prasad Nichenametla**

INVECTIVE FROM SAFFRON COMMENTATORS has him as 'Revanthuddin' and 'Hazrat Reddy', but that doesn't fully account for another facet of Telangana's Congress chief minister: he's got going a Hindu devotional policy *rath* of sorts that's bustling across the entire span of the state. Several major temples across Telangana are undergoing a massive makeover. The renovation spree, set to cost at least Rs 1,700 crore, also goes beyond the big venues, as generous aid flows to several smaller shrines at places like Bhupalapalli, Wyra, Kamareddy and Mahabubabad.

Revanth Reddy, groomed in the Akhil Bharatiya Vidyarthi Parishad (ABVP) in his student days, clearly knows the syllabus. Three modern *gaushalas* with veterinarian care, each spread over 50 to 100 acres, are coming up at Vemulawada, Yadagirigutta and Moinabad. A *gaushala* policy was approved by Revanth's cabinet, and the state police has often cracked down on illegal transport of cows.

There's a touch to Revanth's Hindu outreach that delineates it as his own signature, rather than that of the Congress. On April 6, Revanth, *en famille*, was at the Gnana Saraswati temple at Basara to initiate his grandson into education. Hundreds of couples, precocious pre-pre-schoolers in tow, throng this shrine on the shores of the Goda-